Votas

An Election Monitoring and Situation System

A USER GUIDE

Dart Spatial Nig Limited
Version 3.0

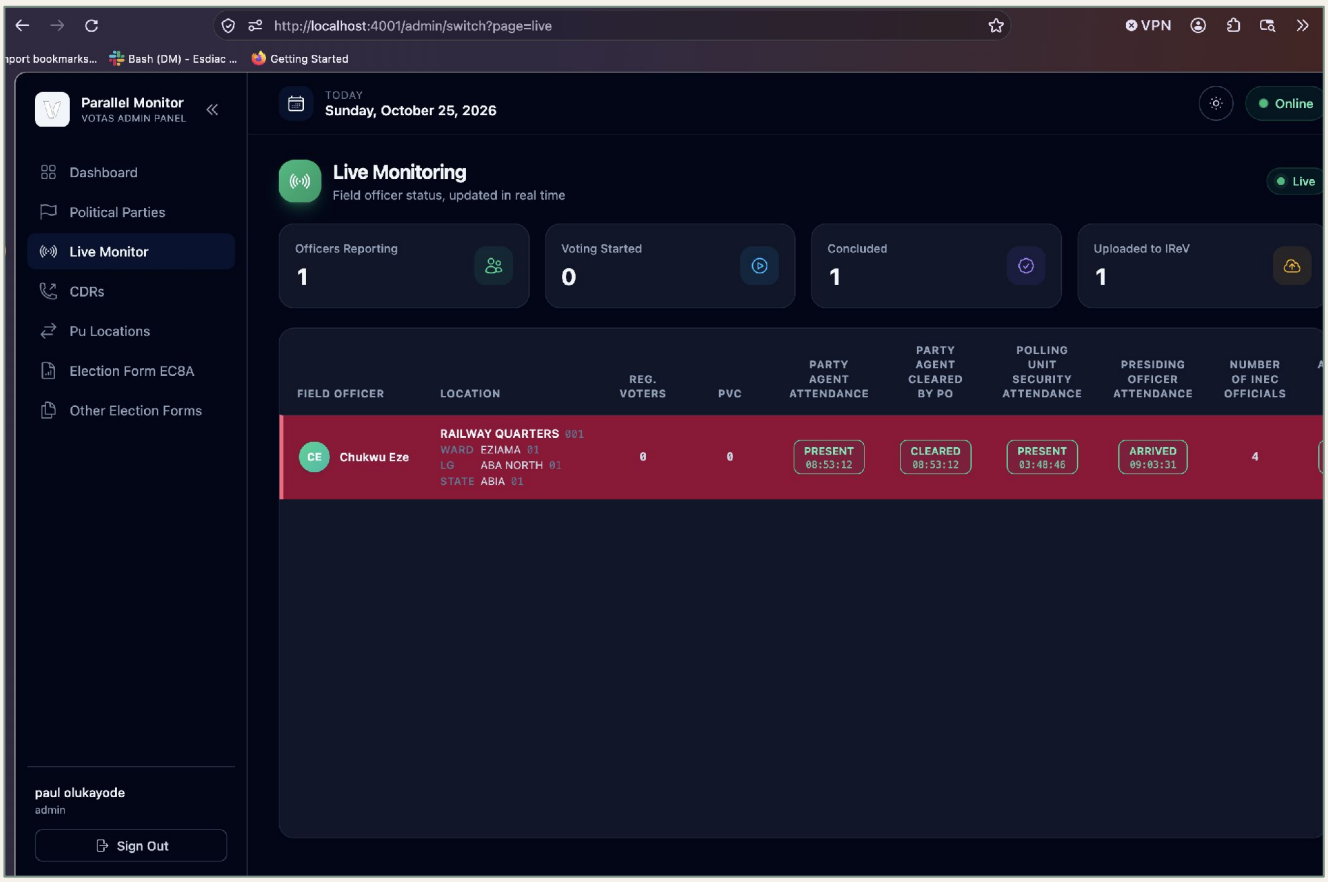
What is Votas

Votas is an election monitoring and situation room system developed by Dart Spatial Nigeria Limited.

The company has years of experience in election matters and understands the gaps in evidence collation for litigation. Votas is built to close those gaps.

Situation room

A room set up to monitor the election, where data from every polling unit arrives live.



The situation room view: the Live Monitoring page of the Votas admin panel.

Offline first

Mobile network operators (MNOs) in Nigeria do not cover every part of the country. Votas keeps working where there is no MNO or PSTN presence.



1. Collect

Polling unit agents collect data on the phone and send it live.



2. Save

With no network, the system saves the data on the device.



3. Push

As soon as a connection is available, the data is pushed.

Nine core modules

Designed to close the major gaps in the monitoring process and in evidence collection.

1. **Election Forms**
2. **Performance Score**
3. **Ward Collation Center**
4. **Party Agent**
5. **PU Election Result**
6. **PU Security**
7. **INEC Presiding Officer**
8. **Incident Report**
9. **Emergency**

Modules 1 to 3

1

Election Forms

One-touch capture and submission of the various election forms provided by INEC, such as EC8A, which records the polling unit result. Each form is captured on the phone and submitted straight to the situation room.

2

Performance Score

Track PU political performance. The agent marks winning or losing and rates it from 1 to 100%.

3

Ward Collation Center

Collate EC8A forms into EC8B and manage the collation process, including security and form upload. Records environment video to confirm the upload was done at a particular place by particular people.

Modules 4 to 6

4 Party Agent

Manage all polling unit agents and supervisors, including arrival and coordination. Coordinates confirm that an agent is at the assigned polling unit.

5 PU Election Result

Lets the polling unit officer view the uploaded result. Results cannot be typed in, only uploaded. Gen2 AI extracts the result from the EC8A sheet, shows it to the officer and pushes it to the Bimip server for the situation room.

6 PU Security

Safeguard the collation process. Manages all security at the polling unit and lets agents send security reports to the situation room.

Modules 7 to 9

7 INEC Presiding Officer

Manage the activities of the INEC presiding officer on election day: arrival, election materials, BVAS management, accreditation and the election process.

8 Incident Report

Capture and escalate incidents in real time. Built-in call, chat, video, image, quick click and audio recording let agents communicate effectively with the situation room.

9 Emergency

In an emergency, a polling unit user can broadcast their location to the situation room for a quick rescue.

Trusted data

All data on Votas is cryptographically signed with a certificate from a respected and trusted Certificate Authority (CA). This makes the data reliable and valid for use in litigation.



Signed

Every record is cryptographically signed.



Trusted CA

The certificate comes from a respected authority.

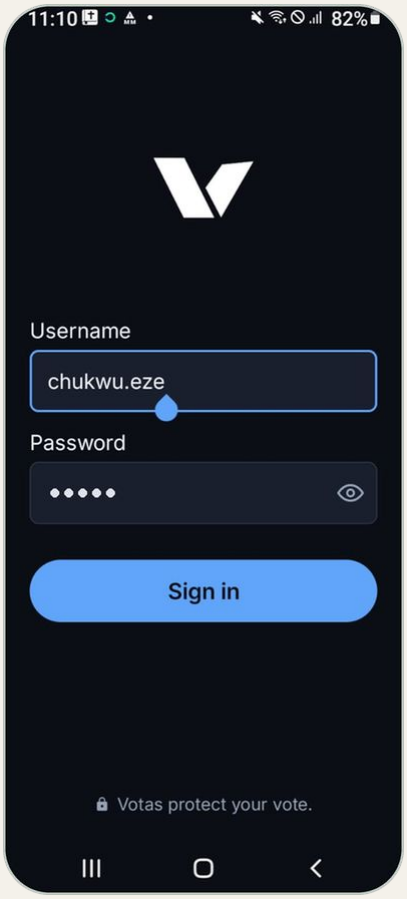


Valid for litigation

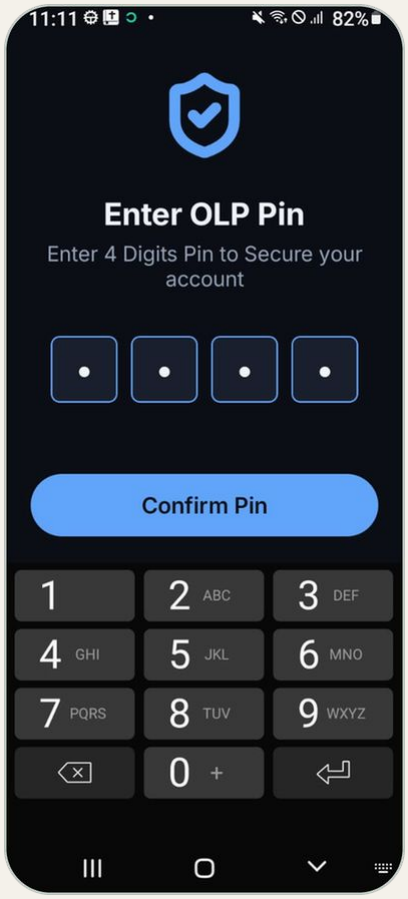
Reliable data that can stand as evidence.

Logging in

Sign in to Votas using the account details and access PIN sent to you by your supervisor. The OLP lets you keep using the system even while offline, because Votas is built on an offline-first principle.



Sign in



Enter OLP PIN

1 Open Votas

Tap the Votas icon on your phone.

2 Enter username

Type the username for your account.

3 Enter password

Type your password. Keep it private and never share it.

4 Tap Sign in

Tap Sign in to continue.

5 Enter the OLP PIN

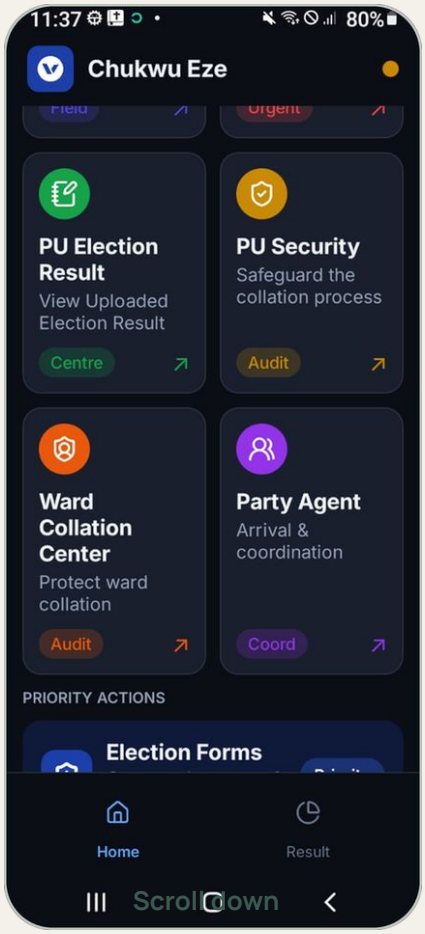
Enter your 4-digit OLP PIN, then tap Confirm Pin. After your first sign-in, Votas starts from the OLP PIN screen, which works without internet

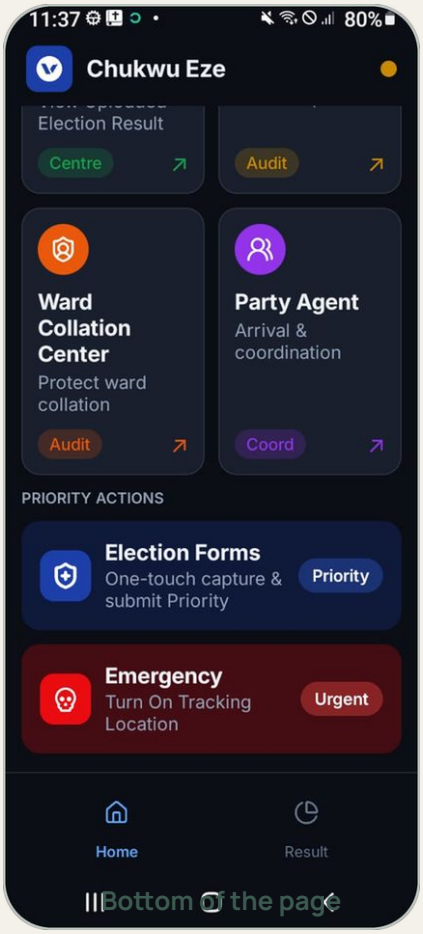
Cannot log in? Check your username and password, then contact 09024550723.

The home page

After you log in, Votas opens on the home page. Scroll down to see every module.







Header

The users' names and the status dot show that the election has not yet commenced. When they turn green, the election has commenced.

Counters

Total PUs in your ward, number of registered voters and total PVCs collected.

Operations and priority actions

The eight module cards. See the next page.

Election card

The election day, the election name, and your state, LG, registration area and PU codes.

Election status

Shows whether the election has started, with the date.

Bottom bar

Switch between Home and Result.

The nine modules

Tap a card on the home page to open its module. The tag on each card is shown as it appears in the app.

1 Election Forms

One-touch capture and submit of the election forms.

Priority

2 Performance Score

Track PU political performance.

Score

3 Ward Collation Center

Protect ward collation.

Audit

4 Party Agent

Arrival and coordination.

Coord

5 PU Election Result

View uploaded election results.

Centre

6 PU Security

Safeguard the collation process.

Audit

7 INEC Presiding Officer

Manage official activities.

Field

8 Incident Report

Capture and escalate incidents in real time.

Urgent

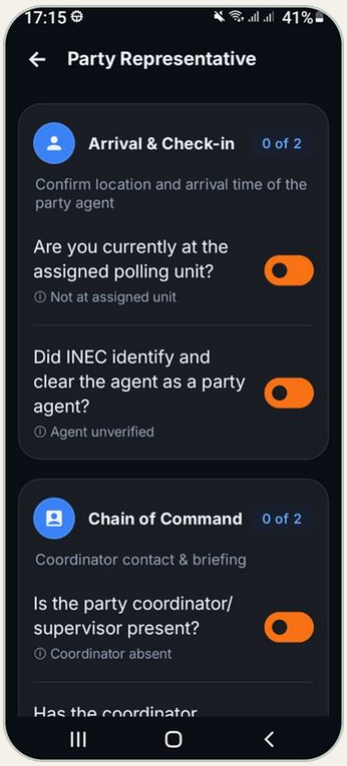
9 Emergency

Broadcast your location to the situation room in an emergency.

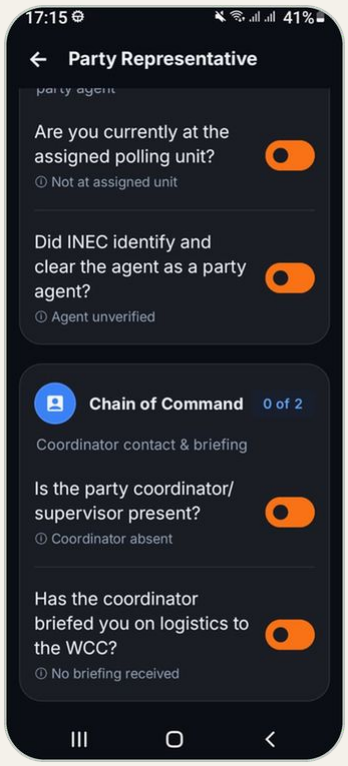
Urgent

Party Agent

Lets the party monitor what its agents do at the polling unit. Parties often report agents who are not at their post.



Top of the screen



Scroll down

Arrival & Check-in

Confirm location and arrival time of the party agent

1. **Are you currently at the assigned polling unit?**
2. **Did INEC identify and clear the agent as a party agent?**

Chain of Command

Coordinator contact & briefing

3. **Is the party coordinator/supervisor present?**
4. **Has the coordinator briefed you on logistics to the WCC?**

WCC is the Ward Collation Center.

How the location check works

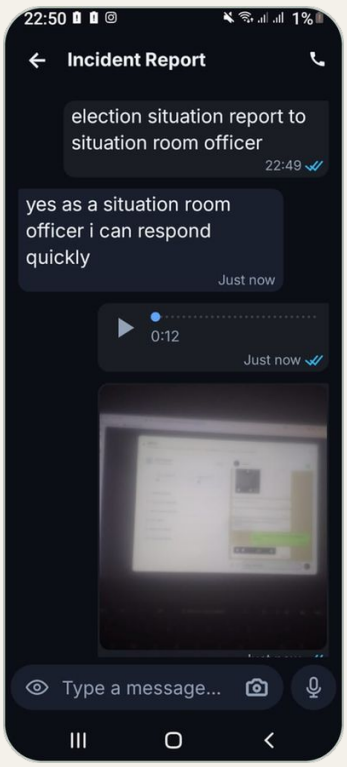
1. **Tap the switch**
   Tap the switch for the first question.
2. **Votas reads your location**
   It takes the current location of your phone.
3. **It compares locations**
   It compares it with **INEC's** location for your unit.
4. **It decides**
   Votas decides if you are at the polling unit.

Before you tap. Stand at your polling unit and make sure your phone's location is turned on.

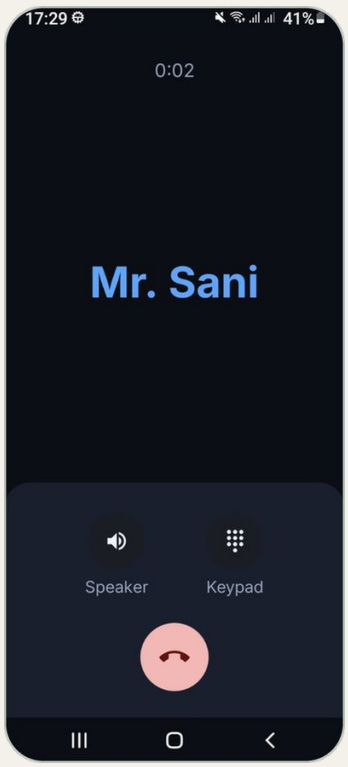
Incident Report

Report what is happening at your polling unit to the situation room in real time, like a chat app.

Works offline. Your reports are saved on the phone. When there is a network, Votas sends everything to the situation room server.



The chat screen



A call in progress

Chat

Write to the situation room officer and read the replies, as in a chat app.

Calls

Tap the phone icon at the top right. Follow the audio menu and press a key on the keypad:

1. **Situation officer**
2. **Emergency unit**
3. **Supervisor**

The situation officer can also call you back.

What you can send

Chat

Message the situation room officer.

Calls

Call the situation officer, emergency unit or supervisor.

Photo and video

Record events and send them as evidence.

Audio

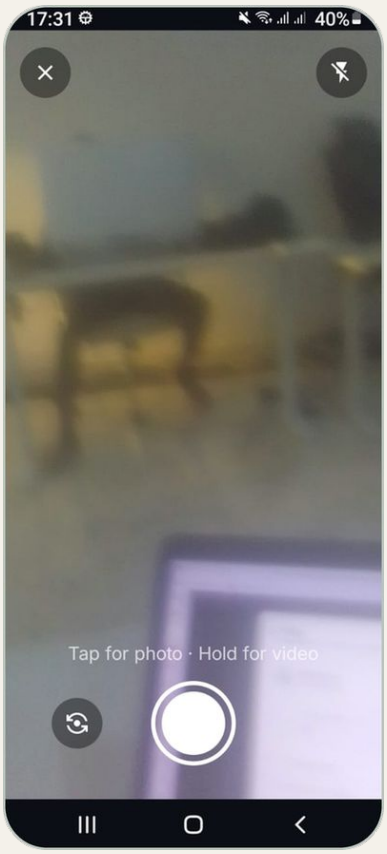
Send a voice message instead of typing.

Quick tags

Pick a ready-made message.

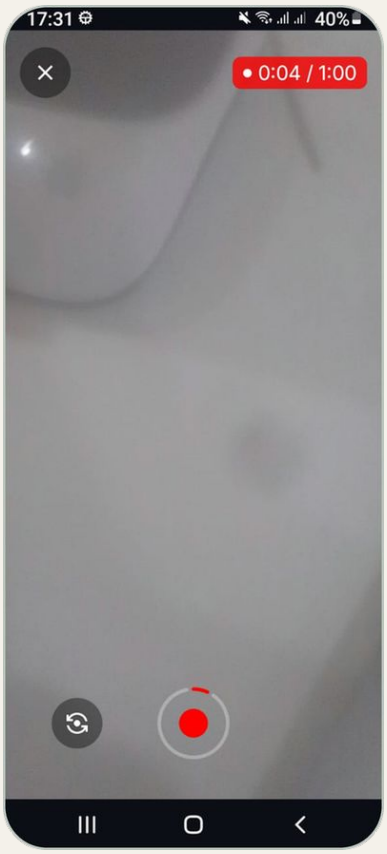
Photos and video

Record events as they unfold and send them to the situation room, as evidence or as information it can act on.



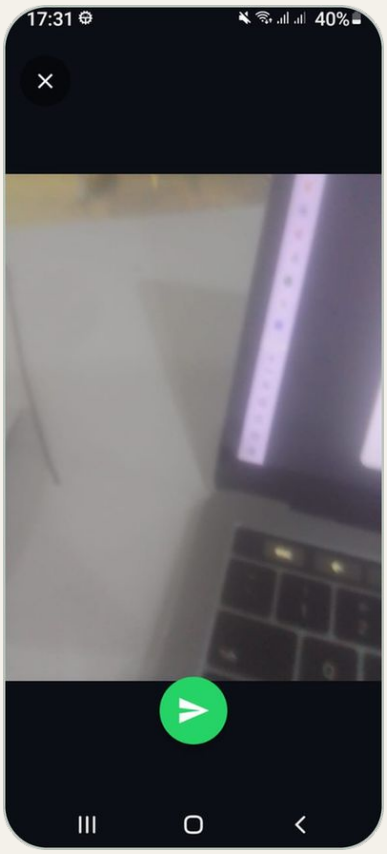
1 Photo or video

Tap the camera icon in the message bar. Tap the round button for a photo, or hold it to record a video.



2 Record video

Keep holding to record. A timer shows how long you have recorded, up to 1 minute.



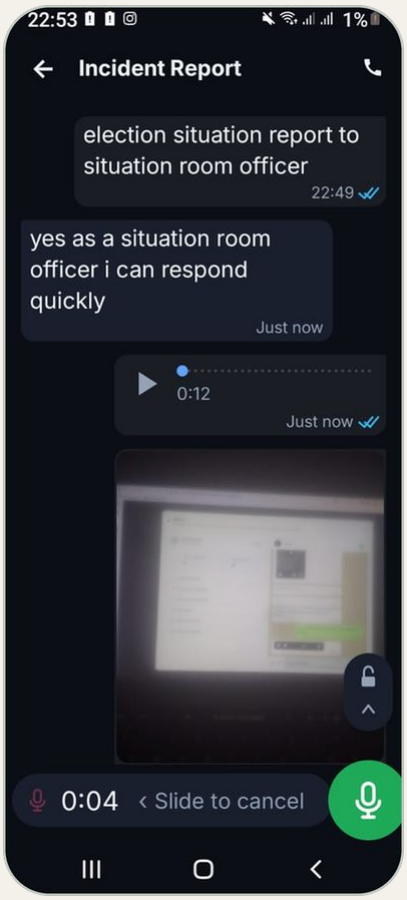
3 Check and send

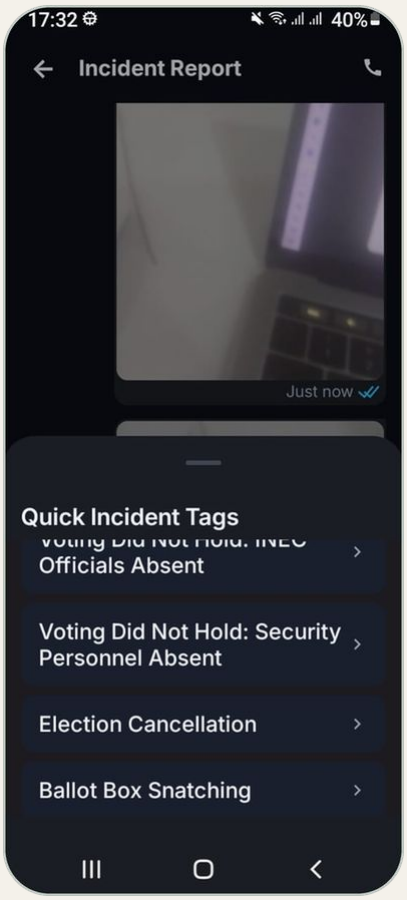
Look at what you captured, then tap the green button to send it to the situation room.

Why send photos and video? They show the situation room what is happening, as evidence or as information it can act on. Use the flash and flip-camera buttons on the camera screen if you need them.

Audio and quick tags

When typing is slow, send a voice message or pick a ready-made message.





1 Send a voice message

Hold the microphone button to record. It turns green while you hold it. Slide left to cancel. Slide up to the lock icon to keep recording without holding the button [confirm].

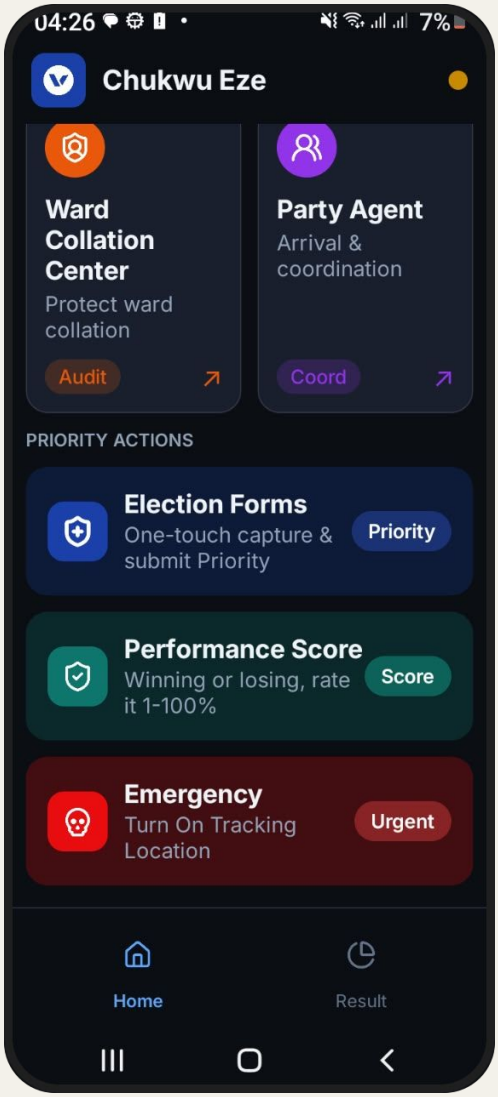
2 Quick Incident Tags

Tap this eye icon in the message bar to open Quick Incident Tags. Pick a ready-made message instead of typing, for example “Ballot Box Snatching” or “Election Cancellation”.

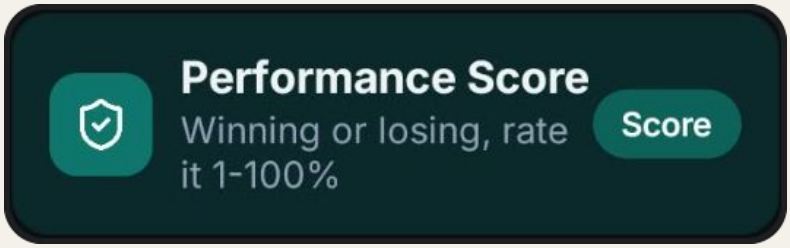
In short. Votas makes it quick for the party agent to send information to the situation room, so the party can decide and respond fast.

Performance Score

Tap Performance Score to say whether your party is winning or losing at your polling unit, and rate it from 1 to 100%.



Performance Score is under Priority actions



What it does

The polling unit officer makes a quick assessment, from his or her own intuition, of whether the party is winning or losing at the unit. It is a judgement call, not a calculated result, and it helps the party make quick decisions.

How to use it

1. **Open the home page.**
   Scroll down to Priority actions.

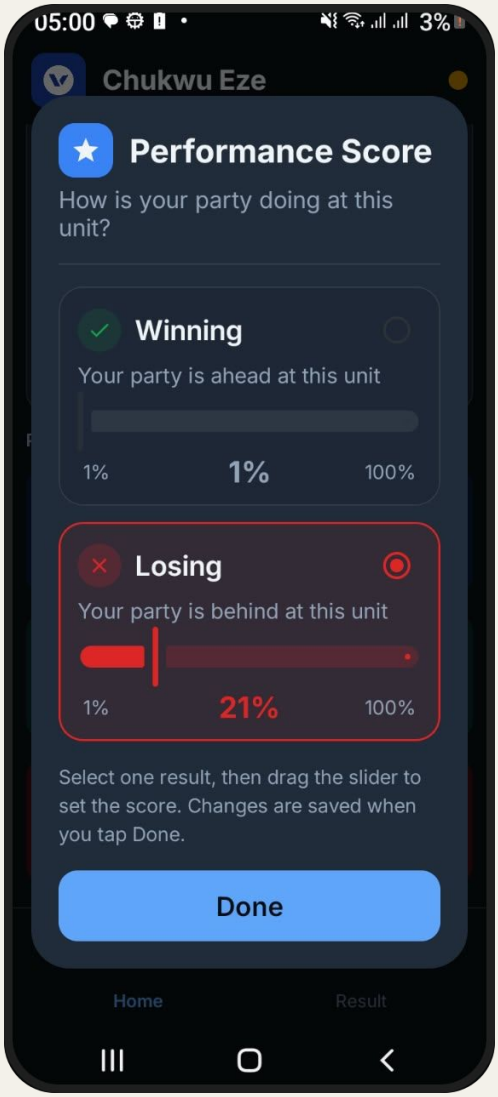
2. **Tap Performance Score.**
   It is the green card: “Winning or losing, rate it 1-100%”.

3. **Set the score and tap Done.**
   See the next page for how.

Use your best judgement. This is your own assessment of the unit. It is not an official result.

Setting the score

After you tap Performance Score, a box asks: “How is your party doing at this unit?”



Choose Winning or Losing, then drag the slider

How to set it

1. **Choose one result.**
   Winning: your party is ahead at this unit.
   Losing: your party is behind at this unit.

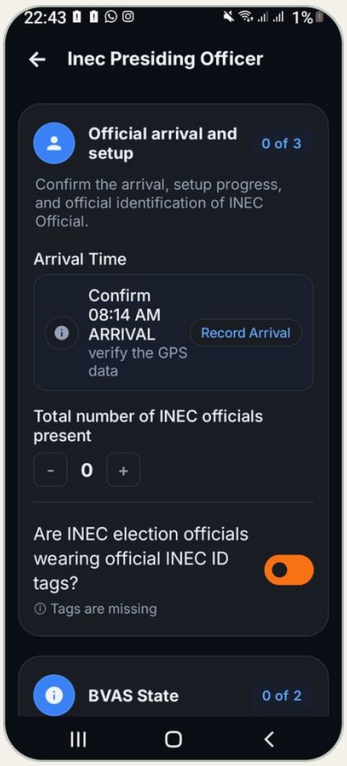
2. **Drag the slider.**
   Set the score from 1% to 100%. The percentage shows under the slider.

3. **Tap Done.**
   Your changes are saved when you tap Done.

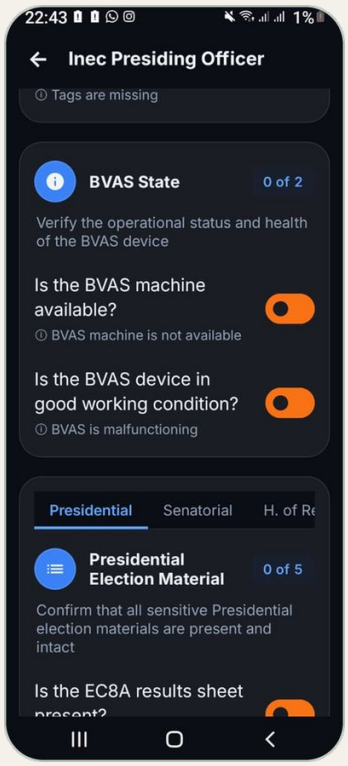
i **Select one result first,** then drag the slider to set the score.

INEC Presiding Officer

Use this module to follow the activities of the INEC presiding officer at your polling unit.



Arrival and setup



BVAS state

Official arrival and setup

Tap Record Arrival to save the time the INEC official arrived. Use + and - to enter how many INEC officials are present, then say whether they wear official INEC ID tags.

BVAS state

Say whether the BVAS machine is available, and whether it is in good working condition.

Your progress

The number at the top right of each card, for example “0 of 3”, shows how many steps are complete.

What this module records

Arrival and setup

When the officials arrive, how many, and whether they wear ID tags.

BVAS state

Whether the BVAS is available and working.

Election materials

EC8A, EC60E, ballot papers and the ballot box for each election.

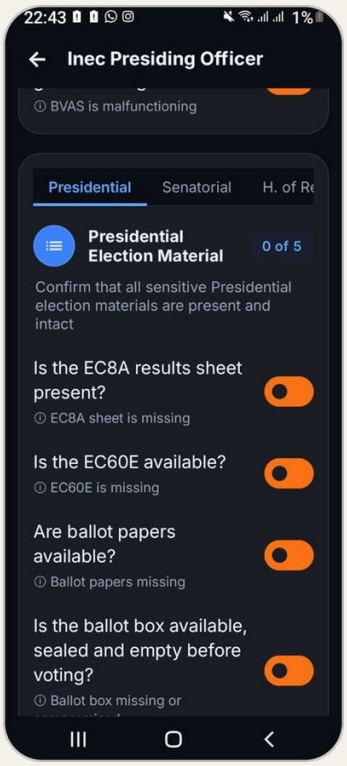
Accreditation and voting

Whether accreditation and voting have started.

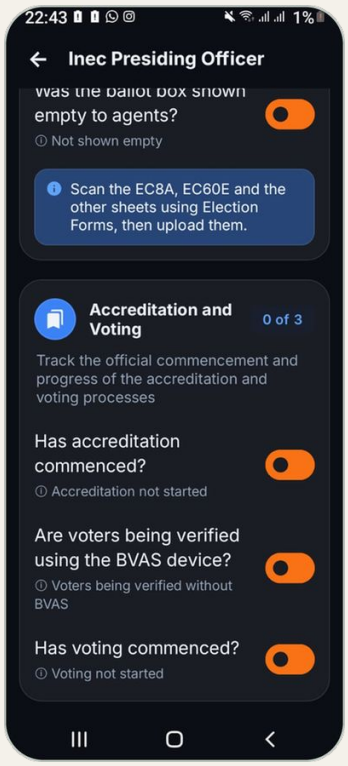
Tip. Each question is a switch. Switch it on when the answer is yes. The line under it describes the current answer, for example “Tags are missing”.

Materials and voting

Confirm the election materials for each election, then follow accreditation and voting.



Election materials



Accreditation, voting

Election materials

Use the tabs to switch between the elections for your polling unit, such as Presidential, Senatorial and H. of Reps. For each election, say whether these are present:

1. **EC8A results sheet**
2. **EC60E**
3. **Ballot papers**
4. **Ballot box, sealed and empty before voting**
5. **Ballot box shown empty to agents**

Accreditation and voting

Say whether accreditation has commenced, whether voters are verified using the BVAS device, and whether voting has commenced.

Scan and upload the election documents

1 Check the materials

Confirm that the EC8A, EC60E, ballot papers and ballot box are present.

2 Open Election Forms

Open it from the home page. It lists the election forms.

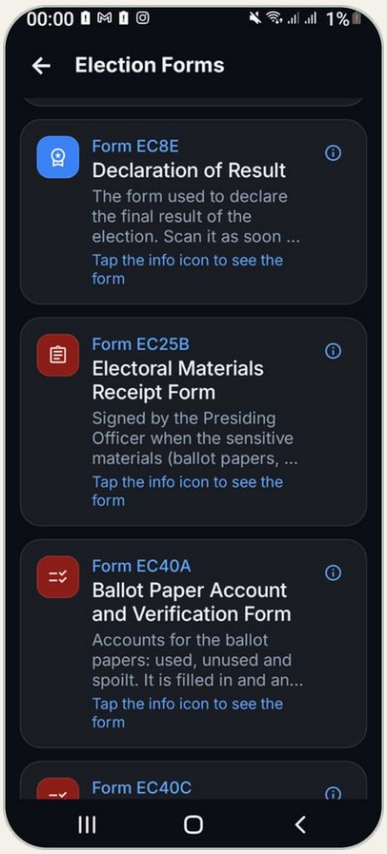
3 Scan and upload

Scan each election document and upload it.

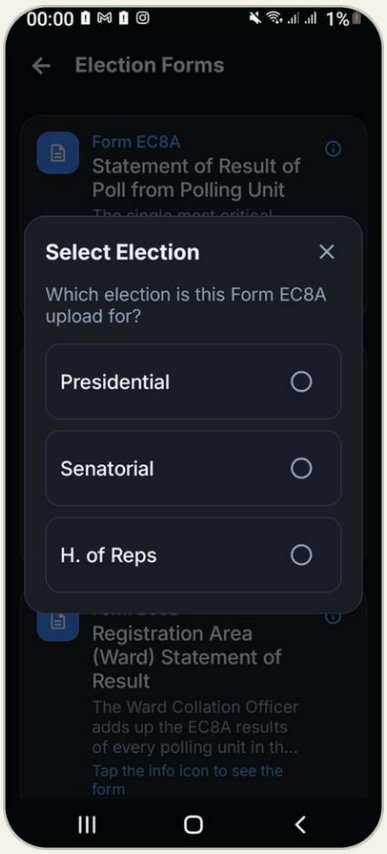
Remember. Use Election Forms to record and scan each election document. This module reminds you with a blue box under the materials questions.

Election Forms

This is where all the INEC election documents are listed. INEC provides these documents for each polling unit.







1 Find the form

Scroll the list to find the document you need. Each card shows the form number, its name and a short description.

2 See the form

Tap this icon on a form card to see how the form looks, in case you have not seen it before. Pinch to zoom, double tap to reset.

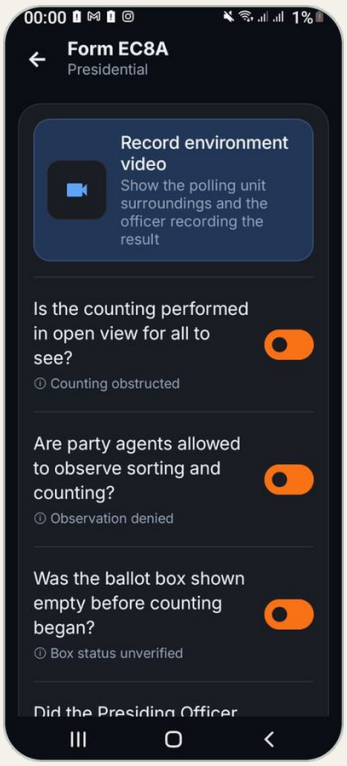
3 Choose the election

Tap the form card. Votas asks which election you are recording the document for.

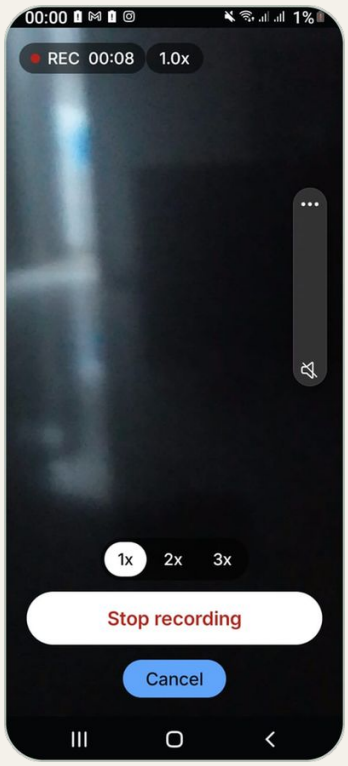
Match each document to an election. Some documents are not specific to one election type. We still recommend mapping each document to an election type.

EC8A and the video

Tap a form such as EC8A and choose the election. A new screen opens. The first step is the environment video.



The EC8A screen



Recording

Why record a video

The video shows how the result was obtained. The EC8A alone is not enough. The video of how the result was recorded is very important if the result is taken to court.

What to show

Keep the face of the INEC official and the surroundings where the result is being recorded in view.

Questions on this screen

Below the video card, Votas asks how the counting was done, for example whether it was in open view.

How to record the video

1 Tap the form

Choose the election. The screen for that form opens.

2 Record the video

Tap Record environment video. Recording starts automatically.

3 Stop recording

Tap Stop recording to finish. Tap Cancel to cancel the recording.

Protected as evidence

Signed with a certificate

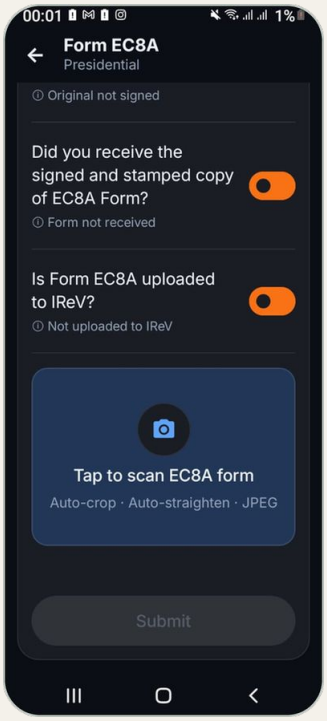
Votas signs the video and the scanned EC8A with a cryptographic certificate. This helps defend them in court.

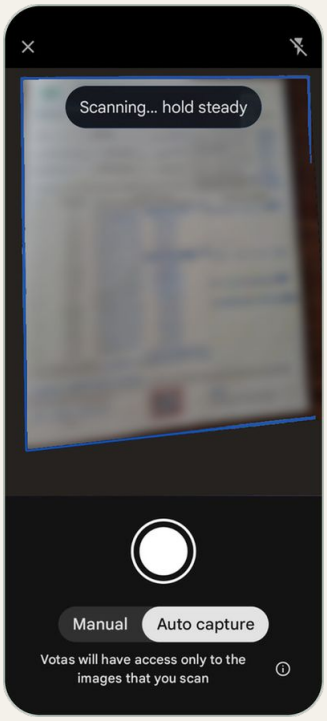
Trusted timestamp (RFC 3161)

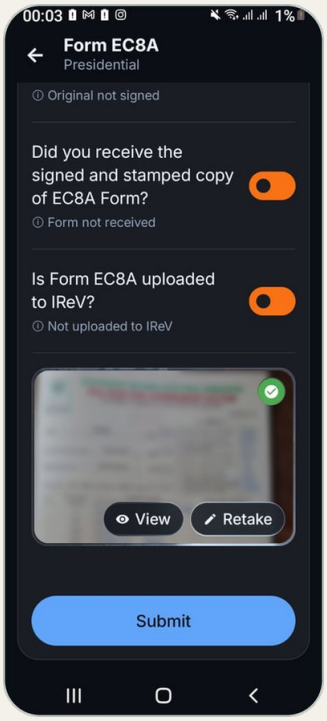
A trusted time authority stamps the exact time on a fingerprint (a SHA-256 hash [confirm]) of the video and the scanned EC8A. This shows they existed then and have not changed since.

Scan and submit

Scan the EC8A with the scanner built into Votas. You do not type the result. Votas reads it from the scan.







1 Tap to scan

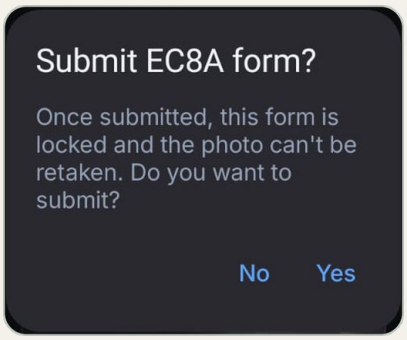
On the EC8A screen, tap Tap to scan EC8A form. The scanner built into Votas opens. It crops and straightens the form for you and saves it as a JPEG.

2 Hold steady

Hold the phone steady over the EC8A. Auto capture takes the picture for you, or switch to Manual. Votas only gets the images you scan.

3 Check the scan

Tap View to look at the scanned EC8A. If you are not satisfied, tap Retake. Submit is available once the form is scanned.



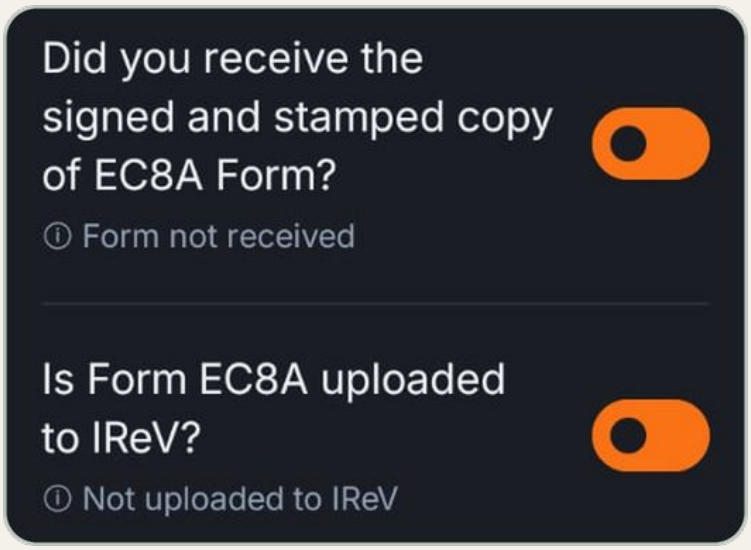
4 Confirm and submit

Tap Submit. A dialog asks you to confirm that all the information is complete. Once submitted, the form is locked and the photo cannot be retaken. Tap Yes to submit.

No typing. Votas Gen2 AI extracts the result and other details from the scan, so there are no typing errors.

IReV and the signed copy

Two questions on the EC8A screen record whether you received the signed copy and whether the result reached IReV.



Signed and stamped copy

Say whether you received the signed and stamped copy of the EC8A form.

Uploaded to IReV

Say whether the EC8A was uploaded to IReV, the INEC Result Viewing portal. This confirmation is very important.

How the situation room checks

1 Result uploaded

The EC8A is uploaded to the INEC IReV portal.

2 You answer

You say whether the EC8A is uploaded to IReV.

3 The situation room checks

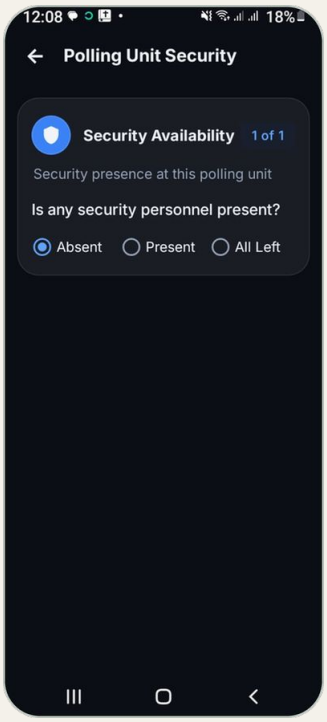
The situation room officer logs in to the INEC IReV portal straight away and confirms the result is there.

Very important. The IReV confirmation lets the situation room check straight away, on the INEC portal, that the result has been uploaded.

Same process for the other forms. Everything on these pages for the EC8A is done the same way for the other election forms.

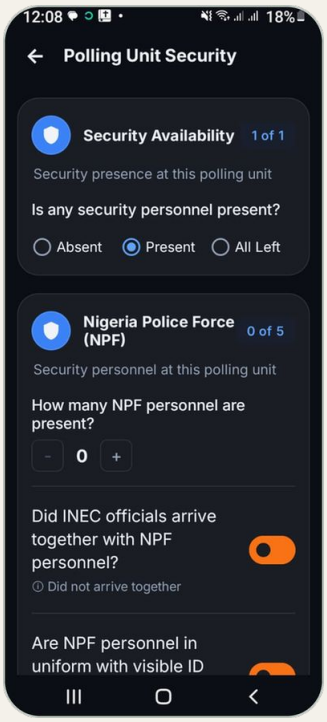
Polling Unit Security

Use this module, as a party agent, to manage the security at your polling unit.



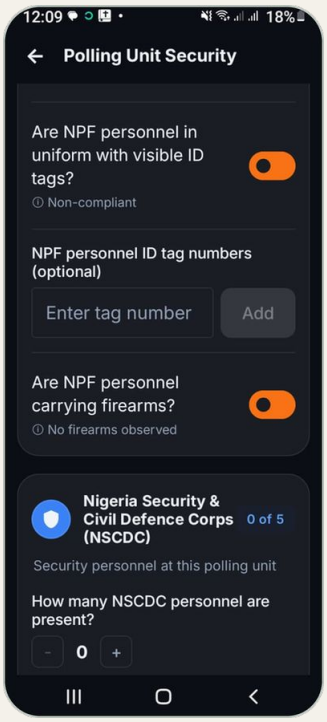
1 Is security present?

Choose Absent, Present or All Left. If you choose Absent, nothing else is asked.



2 Choose Present

The agency cards open: Nigeria Police Force (NPF), NSCDC, Army and DSS. For each agency, enter how many personnel are present.



3 Fill in the rest

Say whether INEC officials arrived together with them, and whether they are in uniform with visible ID tags. Add ID tag numbers (optional). Say whether they carry firearms.

The three choices

Absent

No security personnel at the polling unit. Nothing else is asked.

Present

Security personnel are at the polling unit. The agency cards open.

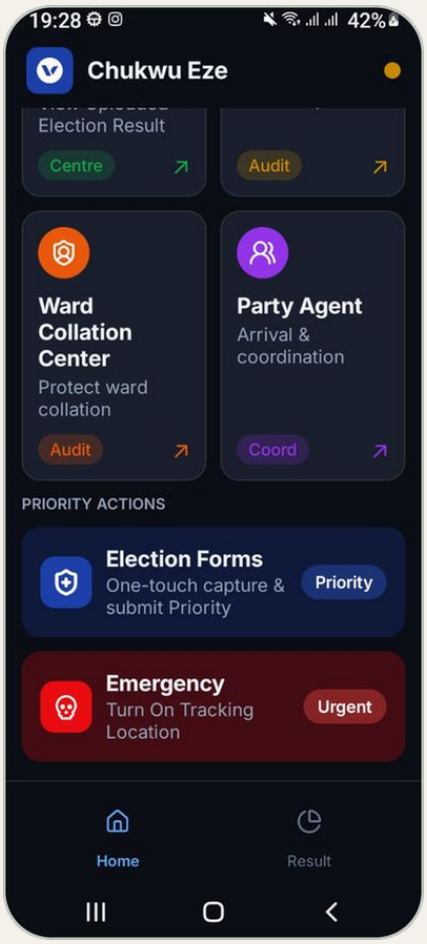
All Left

Security personnel were there, but they have all left. [confirm]

The number at the top right of each card, for example “1 of 1”, shows how many steps are complete.

Emergency

Tap Emergency to broadcast your location to the bimIPs server. It can be used to track you or to find where you are.



Emergency is under Priority actions



What it does

Votas broadcasts your location to the bimIPs server. The server can use it to track the person or to locate the person.

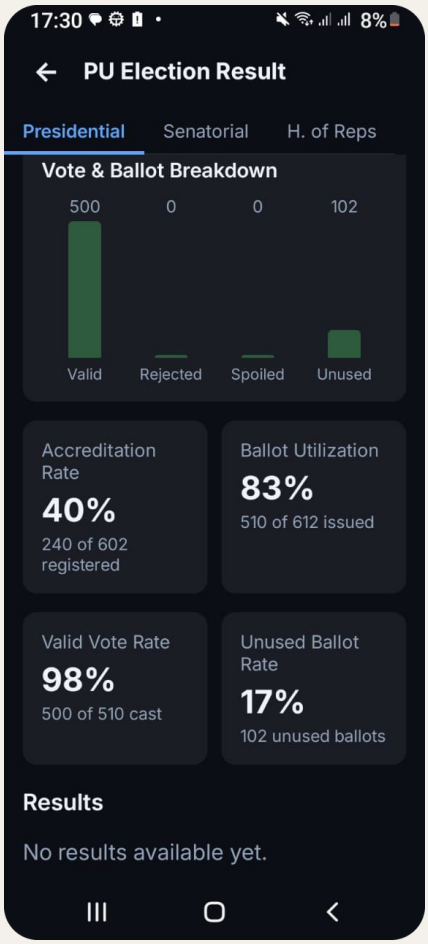
How to use it

1. **Open the home page.**
   Scroll down to Priority actions.
2. **Tap Emergency.**
   It is the red card: “Turn On Tracking Location”.
3. **Your location is broadcast.**
   The bimIPs server receives it.

Use it in an emergency. Make sure your phone’s location is turned on, so your position can be sent.

PU Election Result

This is where you see all the results for the election.



1 Election tabs

Switch between the elections, for example Presidential, Senatorial and H. of Reps.

2 Place and serial number

The name of the place the result is for, where it is (area, local government and state), and a serial number [confirm].

3 Vote & Ballot Breakdown

A bar chart with the number of valid votes, rejected ballots, spoiled ballots and unused ballots.

4 The percentage cards

The four cards under the chart show percentages. They are explained below.

5 Result

The result uploaded from the EC8A form is extracted by **Gen2 AI** to avoid typing errors, and a preview is shown for review.

What the percentages mean

Accreditation Rate

The share of registered voters who were accredited. Example: 240 of 602 registered is 40%.

Ballot Utilization

The share of the issued ballot papers that were used. Example: 510 of 612 issued is 83%.

Valid Vote Rate

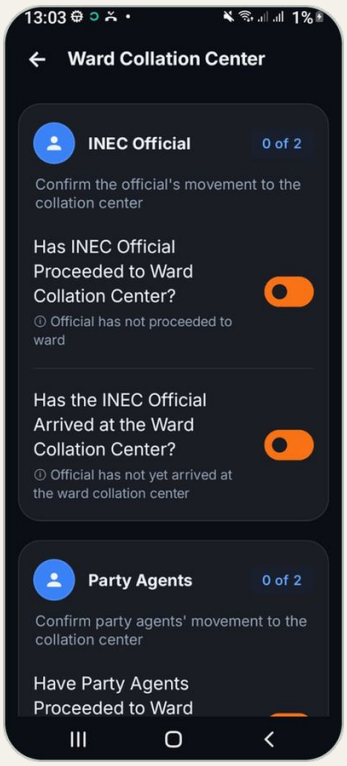
The share of the ballots cast that were valid. Example: 500 of 510 cast is 98%.

Unused Ballot Rate

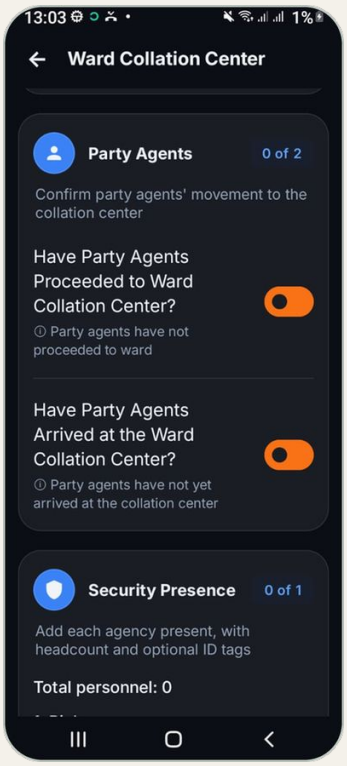
The share of the issued ballot papers that were left unused. Example: 17%.

Ward Collation Center

This is where the activities of the collation center are monitored.



INEC Official



Party Agents

INEC Official

Say whether the INEC official has proceeded to the Ward Collation Center, and whether they have arrived.

Party Agents

Say whether the party agents have proceeded to the Ward Collation Center, and whether they have arrived.

Your progress

The number at the top right of each card, for example “0 of 2”, shows how many steps are complete.

Movement checks

1 Proceeded

The INEC official, or the party agents, have left for the Ward Collation Center.

2 Arrived

They have reached the Ward Collation Center.

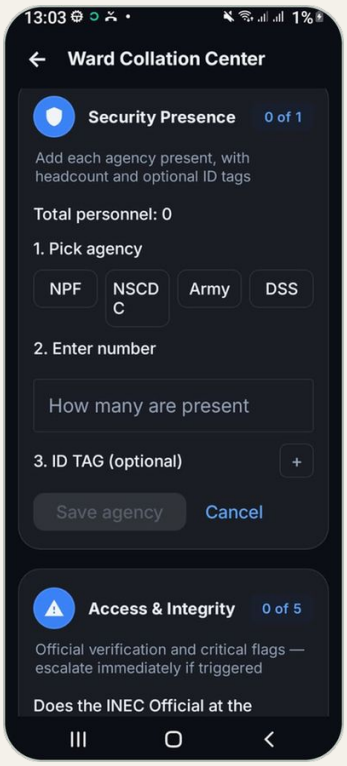
3 Two groups

The same two questions are asked for the INEC official and for the party agents.

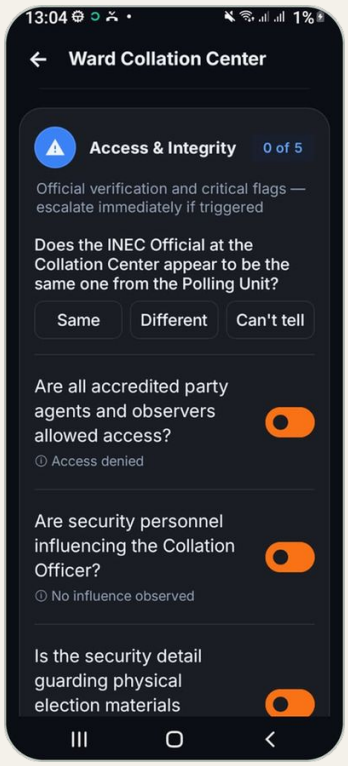
ⓘ **Tip.** Each question is a switch. Switch it on when the answer is yes. The line under it describes the current answer.

Security and access

Record the security agencies at the collation center, and check who has access.



Adding an agency



Access & Integrity

Access & Integrity

These checks verify the official and flag problems. If a flag is triggered, escalate immediately.

1. **Is the INEC official here the same one from the polling unit? Same, Different or Can't tell.**
2. **Are all accredited party agents and observers allowed access?**
3. **Are security personnel influencing the Collation Officer?**
4. **Is the security detail guarding the election materials?**
5. **Is anyone trying to bribe or coerce security? [confirm]**

Adding a security agency

1. **Pick the agency**
   NPF, NSCDC, Army or DSS.
2. **Enter number**
   How many personnel are present.
3. **ID tags**
   Optional. Tap + to add tag numbers.
4. **Save agency**
   Tap Save agency. Tap Cancel to leave without saving.

Scan the EC8B and record the environment. Use Election Forms to scan the EC8B and to record the environment video. The process is the same as for the EC8A.

Monitoring DashBoard

Election Monitoring dash board allow the polling unit offer and the situation room officer to effectively communivcated. The Newaday election need queck and urgent response to from from each party. The help for quick decision making

1 Report in real time

Chat, call, and send photos, video, audio or quick tags, even offline.

2 Protect the result

Record the environment video and scan the EC8A. Both are **signed** and **timestamped**.

3 Check the result

Confirm the IReV upload and see every result in Result and Ward.

4 Watch the polling unit

Follow the INEC presiding officer and the security agencies.

5 Coordinate

Check that your party agent arrived and was briefed.

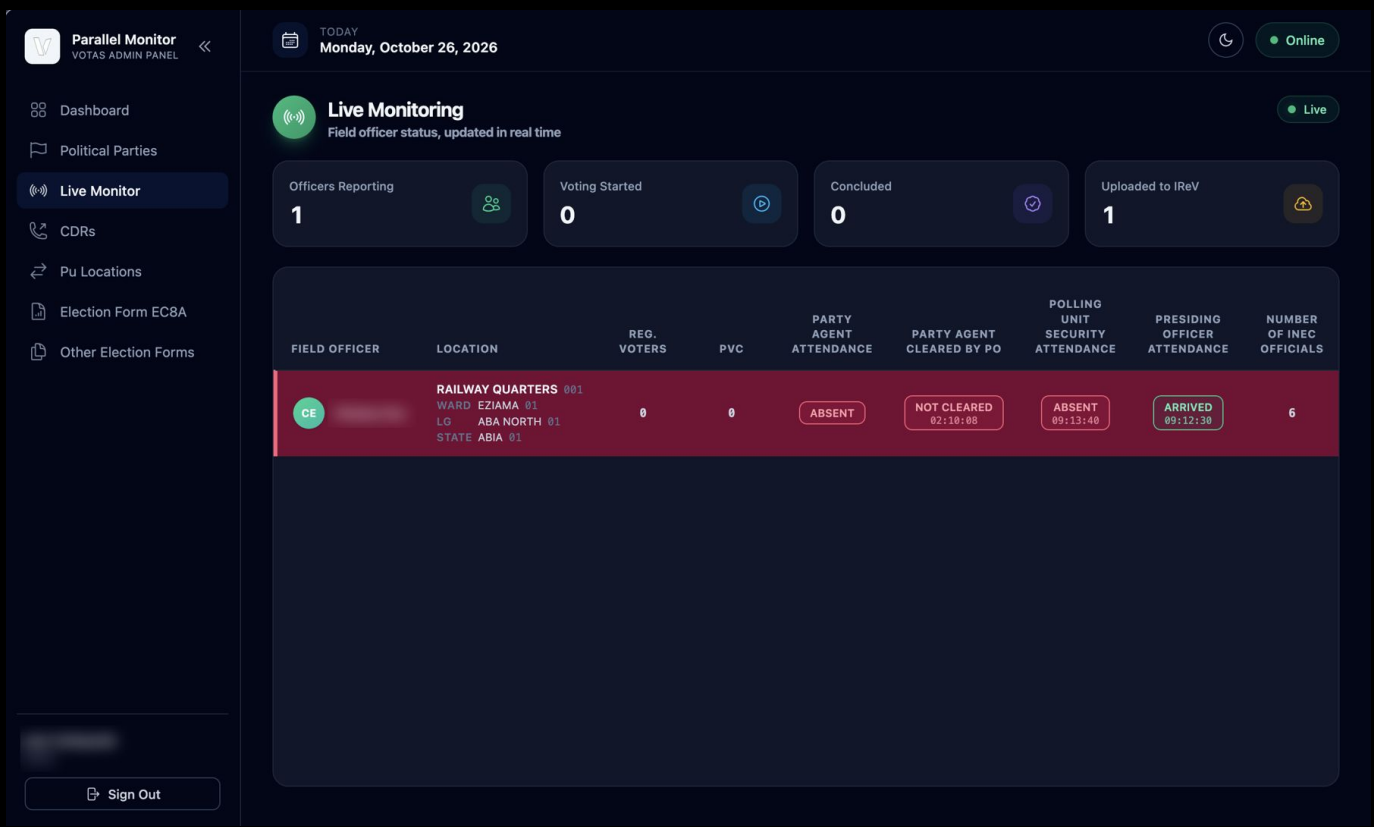
6 Call for help

Tap Emergency to broadcast your location.

Election Monitoring Dashboard

Votas Parallel Monitor: a situation room view of every polling unit, on election day.

Sample dashboard presentation



Election day, from one screen

Monitor party agents and polling unit officers from anywhere, even from home.



Live Monitor

Watch polling unit incidents as they happen, with video, audio, chat, calls and images.



Election Form EC8A

Collect every EC8A scan from the polling units, with the environment video.

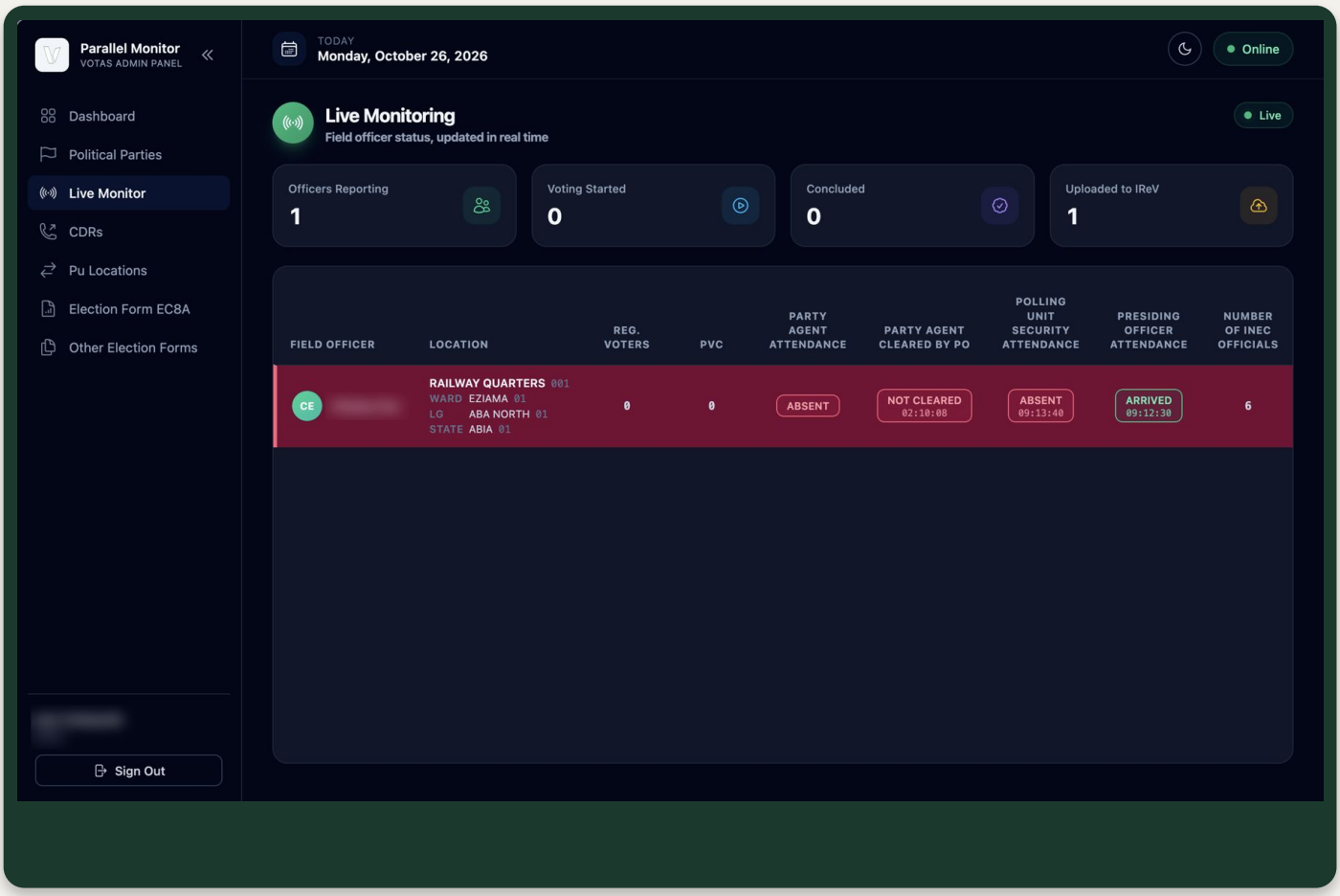


Other Election Forms

Keep EC8B, other INEC forms and election materials in one place.

Live Monitor

Every polling unit incident, in real time.



Video
Footage sent from the polling unit

Audio
Voice notes from the field

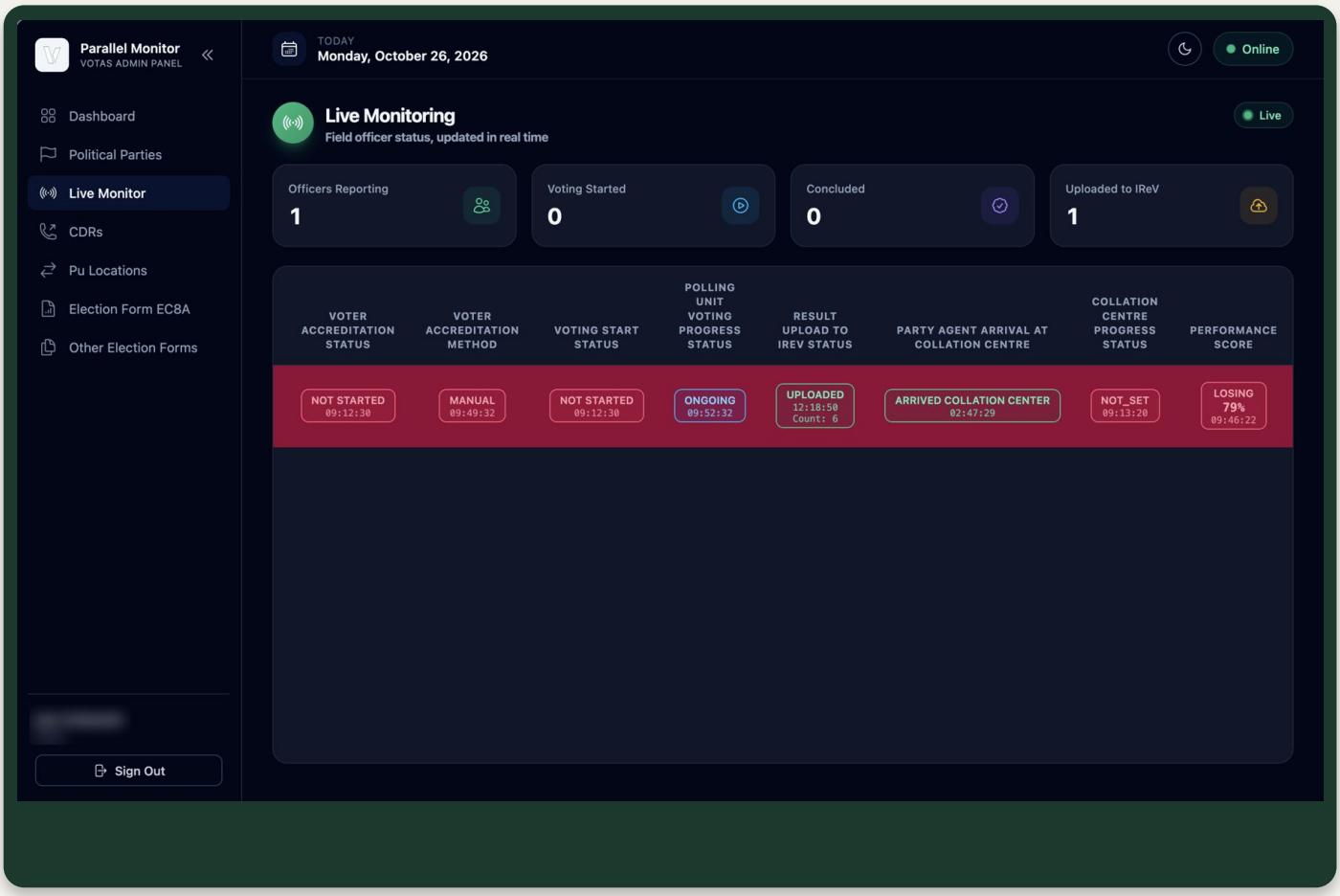
Chat
Message officers directly

Call
Ring an officer in one tap

Images
Photos of what is happening

Live status tracker

Colour-coded alerts with a timestamp show where each polling unit stands.



Accreditation

Voter accreditation status and method

Voting progress

Voting start and polling unit voting status

Result upload

IReV upload status, time and count

Collation centre

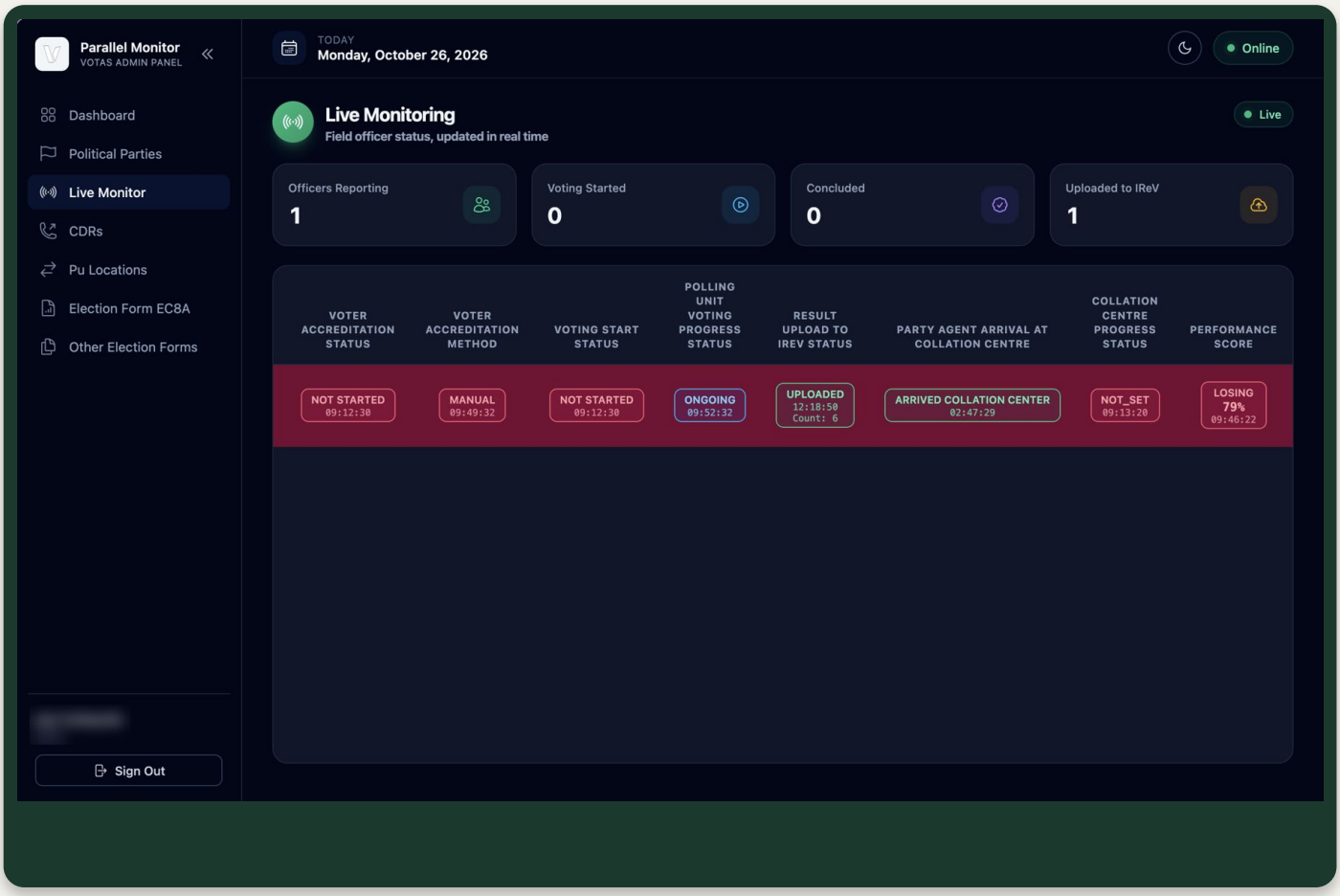
Party agent arrival and centre progress

Performance score

Shows if a unit is winning or losing

Read the status at a glance

Every badge is colour-coded and stamped with the time it last changed.



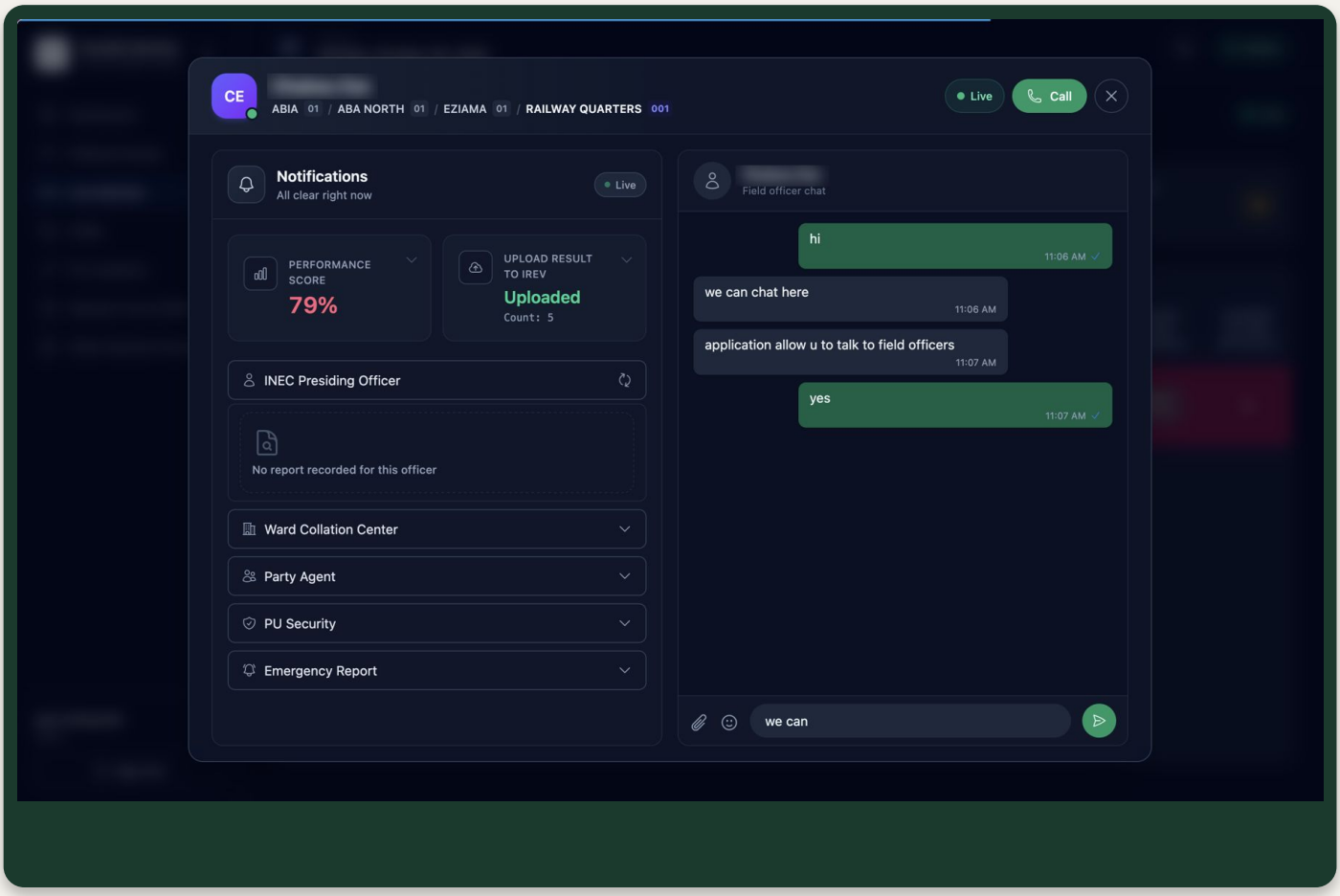
NOT STARTED — Needs attention: a step has not begun or the score is losing

ONGOING — In progress: voting is under way at the polling unit

UPLOADED — Done: the result is on IReV or the agent has arrived

Talk to any field officer

Open an officer to chat, call and review their status.



Built-in chat

Message the officer from the panel

Performance score

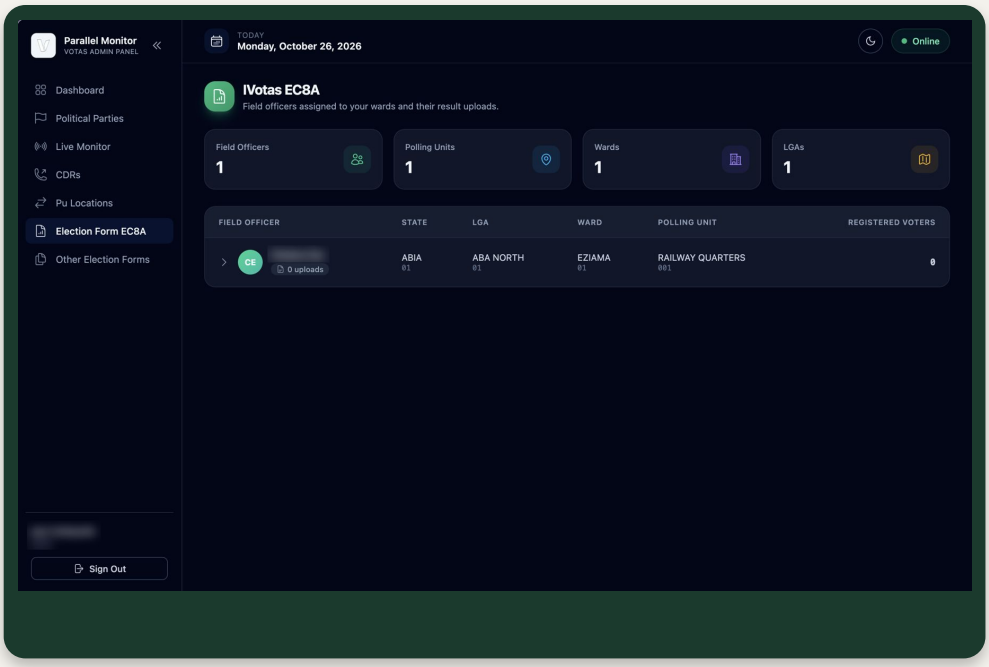
Plus the IReV upload result

Emergency report

Party agent, PU security and ward center

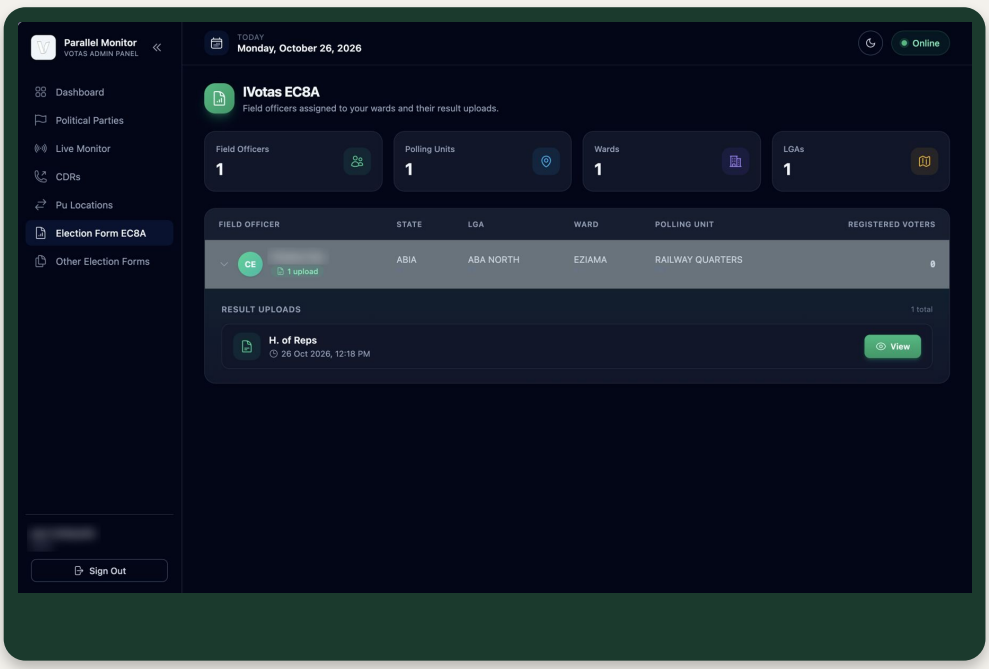
Election Form EC8A

Collate every EC8A scan, plus the environment video that shows how it was captured.



1

Officers listed by ward and polling unit

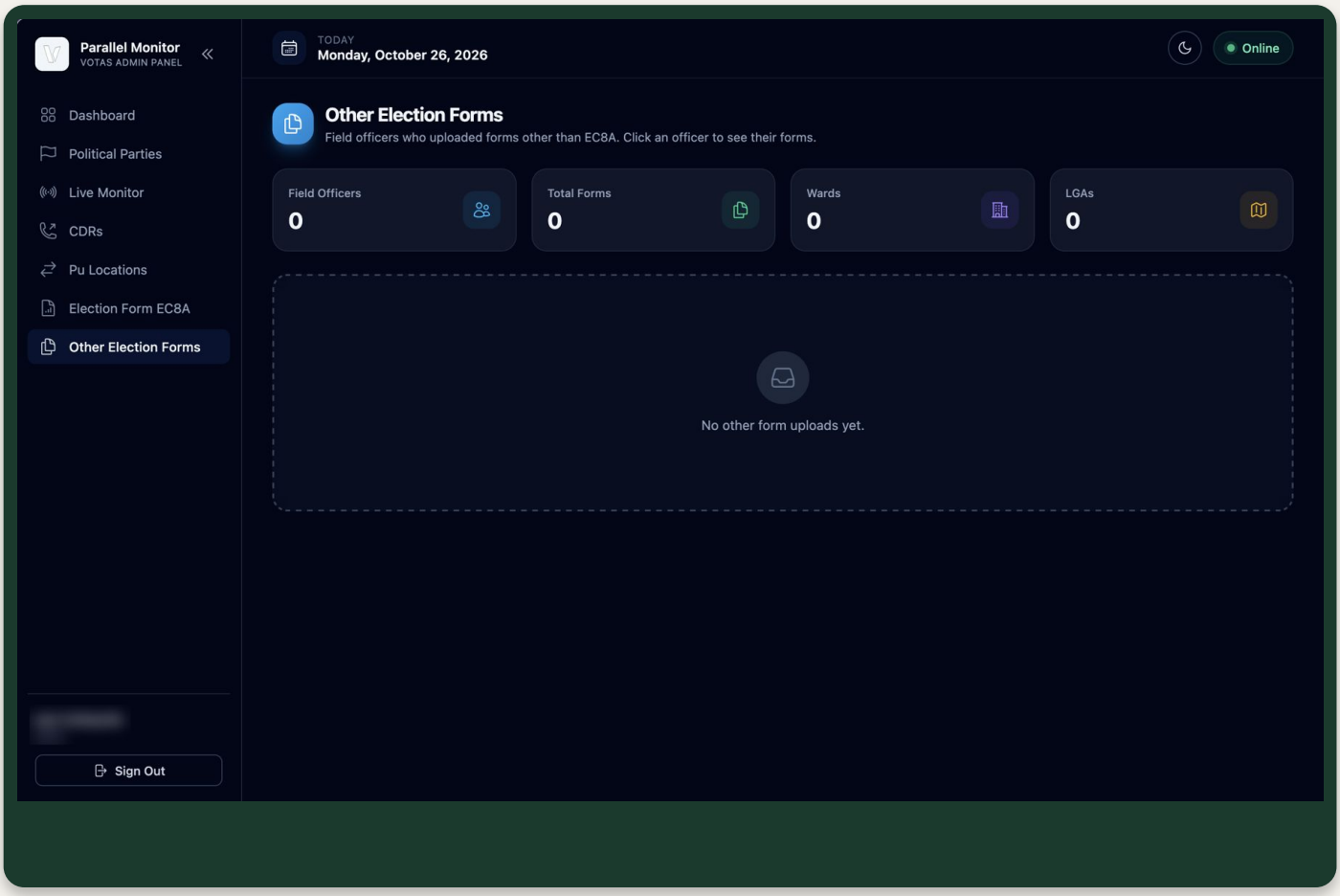


2

Open an officer to view result uploads

Other Election Forms

Everything else the polling unit has to report.



EC8B

Collation forms

Other INEC forms

Any other official form

Election materials

Delivery and usage records

Monitoring Dashboard

Polling units and the situation room stay in touch, so decisions are made fast.

Report in real time
Chat, call, and send photos, video, audio or quick tags, even offline.

Protect the result
Record the environment video and scan the EC8A. Both are signed and timestamped.

Check the result
Confirm the IReV upload and see every result in Result and Ward.

Watch the polling unit
Follow the INEC presiding officer to collation center.

Coordinate
Check that your party agent arrived and was briefed.

Call for help
Tap Emergency to broadcast your location.

In conclusion

Votas helps the party agent report from the polling unit in real time, with or without a network, and keep evidence of how the result was obtained.

1 Report in real time

Chat, call, and send photos, video, audio or quick tags, even offline.

2 Protect the result

Record the environment video and scan the EC8A. Both are **signed** and **timestamped**.

3 Check the result

Confirm the IReV upload and see every result in Result and Ward.

4 Watch the polling unit

Follow the INEC presiding officer and the security agencies.

5 Coordinate

Check that your party agent arrived and was briefed.

6 Call for help

Tap Emergency to broadcast your location.

Thank you for using Votas. Need help? Contact 09024550723.

Address:
Shimi Estate, Km 9,
Keffi-Abuja Expressway,
Keffi Nasarawa State.

web:
votas.com.ng

Phone/WhatsApp:
+2349024550723

Email:
info@votas.com.ng